SKYLAR DAMIANO

Senior Systems Administrator & IT Engineer | Identity (Okta) | Endpoint (Jamf, Intune) | Automation | SOC 2
Chicago, IL | skylardamiano@gmail.com | Okta Certified Administrator | Jamf 200 | Jamf 300

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Chicago-based systems administrator and IT engineer with 8+ years running identity, endpoint, and SaaS for high-growth, remote-first companies, most recently as Staff Systems Administrator at NerdWallet. I own Okta (Certified Administrator), Google Workspace, Entra ID, and Microsoft 365; manage Mac and Windows fleets with Jamf Pro (200 & 300 certified), Intune, and Kandji; and automate onboarding, offboarding, and SaaS lifecycle with Okta Workflows, the Workday API, Bash, and PowerShell. I own SOC 2 evidence as a control owner, have led identity integration across five acquisitions, and use Claude Code daily to automate operations under change control.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Sabbatical: Independent Technical Upskilling | Self-directed | Chicago, IL
January 2025 – Present

- Ran a 50+ client Ubiquiti UniFi network (UDM Pro, 8 access points, switching) as an AI-assisted operations lab: Claude Code ran a read-only audit, then applied approved changes that put all APs on non-overlapping 2.4 GHz channels at lower power
- Replaced the ISP gateway with an XGS-PON SFP+ ONT, removing double NAT; set up dual-WAN failover, IPv6 prefix delegation, and firewall and VPN configuration; fixed a DHCP issue that was handing out retired DNS servers
- Set up MCP servers for Home Assistant, Synology NAS, UniFi, and HomeKit, moving credentials from plaintext JSON into the macOS Keychain; ran Home Assistant in Docker
- Wrote reusable Claude skills (a Python audio sample-pack builder and a playlist automation tool) and CLAUDE.md guardrails; ran agents under change control with backups, dry runs, and change logs

Project: netstack (github.com/gayrobot/netstack)

- Built a public, reusable framework for running a home network with an AI agent under governance: read-only by default, writes only through separate connections where every call is approved, and every change logged in git with diff, rollback, and verification
- Risky changes are gated on a fresh, hash-verified, off-box gateway backup; the NAS pulls the gateway backup nightly, encrypts it to an offline key, and stores it under immutable snapshots
- Git hooks and a CI job block commits that leak real hostnames or inventory; every MCP server is vetted and pinned before use

Project: damiano.dev

- Building a personal site where an AI agent proposes every change as a pull request and I review and merge; the real project is the harness of checks, permissions, and policies that lets an agent change the site safely
- Astro static site with a schema-validated resume, so bad data fails the build; branch protection on main; CI and deployment to Cloudflare Workers through GitHub Actions in progress

Staff Systems Administrator | NerdWallet | San Francisco, CA
May 2020 – January 2025

Automation, Integration & Identity

- Automated account activation and deactivation with Okta Workflows and the Workday API, with Workday as the source of truth for Okta; replaced a manual IT task that took about 2 hours a week with a background process, so onboarding and offboarding run automatically
- Led the migration of onboarding and offboarding automations from BetterCloud to Okta Workflows with little oversight: mapped what each platform did, cut what was redundant, moved the rest, and saved thousands of dollars in tool spend
- Owned monitoring and alerting for production Okta Workflows automations: failures routed by severity to Slack notifications or to tickets, so issues were triaged and resolved without manual checking
- Used ChatGPT to parse data into Okta Workflows and to review Dropbox security logs without a SIEM; wrote Bash and PowerShell automation for provisioning and compliance
- Owned Okta and Google Workspace identity: SSO (SAML/OIDC), SCIM provisioning, group and role models, MFA, conditional access, and privileged access management; administered 1Password and email authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC); rolled out phishing-resistant MFA (FIDO2/WebAuthn) and device trust

- Owned identity and access evidence for SOC 2 as a control owner: access reviews, entitlement cleanup, and audit-ready reporting; built Jira Service Management workflows that held up in quarterly SOC 2 audits
- Enabled and configured Slack AI and Zoom AI and administered ChatGPT; led identity, endpoint, and security integration across five mergers and acquisitions

Endpoint Management & End-User Support

- Ran the Mac and Windows fleet with Jamf Pro, Kandji, and Intune: zero-touch provisioning (Apple Business Manager and Windows Autopilot), configuration profiles, patching, OS upgrades, and security baselines, with FileVault (macOS) and BitLocker (Windows) disk encryption enforced at fleet scale; kept Jamf scripts and configuration under version control in GitHub; completed a full Kandji-to-Jamf Pro migration
- Introduced Torii (SaaS management, now part of SailPoint) to NerdWallet to discover and govern SaaS applications
- Supported a fully remote workforce through Jira Service Management; documented runbooks so other teams could operate what was built; built out office IT and network infrastructure for NerdWallet offices

IT Specialist | ActiveCampaign | Chicago, IL
June 2018 – April 2020

- Implemented Okta and Google Workspace identity for a 560+ person company, owning SSO, MFA, provisioning, and SOC 2 control evidence as the primary IT owner
- Built production Zapier automation that onboarded devices from the company CRM; featured in a Zapier customer article
- Managed IT asset inventory and hardware lifecycle for the office and remote staff; administered Proofpoint email security
- Supported office network equipment, including Cisco Meraki, and shared-space technology for a growing Chicago office; managed Chrome Enterprise and Jamf Pro
- Managed endpoint security and compliance with Jamf and scripting automation; implemented AWS infrastructure using Terraform to support internal tooling

Senior Help Desk Technician | InnerWorkings | Chicago, IL
April 2016 – May 2018

- Escalation point for identity, endpoint, and access issues; supported access reviews and mentored junior technicians
- Tracked hardware asset inventory and device assignments across the organization; supported Proofpoint email security administration

Help Desk Consultant | University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee | Milwaukee, WI
May 2014 – May 2015

- Supported enterprise IT systems; authored documentation and delivered technical training

CORE COMPETENCIES

Automation & IaC: Okta Workflows, Workday API, REST APIs and webhooks, Bash/zsh, PowerShell, Python (developing), Terraform (AWS), Zapier, Git/GitHub, Docker (Home Assistant)
Identity & SaaS: Okta (Certified Administrator; SSO, SCIM, Workflows), Entra ID/AD, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Atlassian (Jira, Confluence, JSM), Slack, Zoom, SAML, OIDC, FIDO2/WebAuthn, conditional access, privileged access management, 1Password, SPF/DKIM/DMARC, license and vendor management
AI & Agents: Claude Code, MCP servers, Claude skills, CLAUDE.md guardrails, agent change control, Slack AI, Zoom AI, ChatGPT, Gemini
Endpoint & Network: Jamf Pro (200 & 300), Kandji, Intune, Windows Autopilot, macOS zero-touch (ABM), FileVault and BitLocker, policy enforcement and scripted remediation, Cisco Meraki, Ubiquiti UniFi, DNS, VPN and firewall (home stack), dual-WAN
Security & Compliance: Zero Trust, Proofpoint, Gmail routing rules, SPF/DKIM/DMARC, privileged access, disk encryption (FileVault/BitLocker), SOC 2 control ownership, access reviews, audit evidence, certificate renewals, Jira Service Management, vendor and MSP management, runbooks and documentation

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Science, Information Science & Technology — University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
Okta Certified Administrator | Jamf 200 | Jamf 300